

Quick Lunches

Margherita Pizza Quesadillas



1 flour tortilla (wheat, multigrain, or white)
1 tomato, sliced
4 large basil leaves, chopped
3 oz. of mozzarella (fresh mozzarella is best, but expensive)

1. Heat a large skillet over medium-high heat.
2. Place the tortilla in the pan, and layer the tomato, mozzarella, and basil leaves on one half of the tortilla. Cook for a minute before folding the empty half of the tortilla over the other side. Cook for another two minutes, or until the cheese is beginning to melt and the underside of the tortilla is brown. Slip, and cook until this side is also brown. Slice and serve!

Recipe and picture courtesy of thekitchenpaper.com

Fajita Style Quesadillas

1 tbsp. canola or olive oil
½ onion, cut into strips
½ red bell pepper, cut into strips
½ green bell pepper, cut into strips (if desired, you can just use 1 kind of bell pepper)]
4 oz. cheese
Optional toppings: salsa, guacamole, cilantro, limes

1. Heat oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat. Add onion and peppers and cook, stirring for 4 minutes until vegetables are tender but still crisp and lightly browned. Remove vegetables from pan onto a plate and set aside.
2. Lightly coat one side of a tortilla with cooking spray and place oiled side down in the skillet over medium heat. Add ¼ of the cheese and place a second tortilla sprayed with cooking spray on top.
3. Cook quesadillas about 2 minutes on each side until cheese is melted and tortillas are lightly browned. Repeat with remaining ingredients.
4. Slice and serve with desired toppings!

Recipe adapted from therecipecritic.com.

Homemade Crunchwrap Supreme

Large (burrito size) tortilla shells
Small tostada shells (or corn tortilla, or tortilla chips)
Queso sauce
Pre-cooked taco meat
Shredded lettuce
Shredded Cheese
Sour cream
Optional ingredients: taco sauce, jalapenos, bell or banana peppers, black or refried beans, olives, tomatoes

1. Warm your tortilla in the microwave to make it soft enough to bend.
2. Put a dollop of queso sauce in the center of your tortilla, but be sure to leave a wide edge so you can wrap it.
3. Spoon some taco meat on the cheese (beans too, if you want to add them). Place the tostada shell, corn tortilla, or tortilla chips on top of the meat.
4. Spoon a dollop of sour cream and spread over the shell. Sprinkle some shredded lettuce and shredded cheese on top (this is where you would add tomatoes, etc.)
5. Wrap the edges up toward the center until they close around your filling (if it won't cover it all, tear a piece off another tortilla to cover)
6. Flip into a warm non-stick pan, fold-side down. Lightly press with spatula to seal the folds and brown. 2-3 minutes
7. Carefully flip over once browned, and brown the bottom side, 2-3 minutes.

Recipe adapted fromfreshdreamer.com



Taco Meat for Crunchwrap Supreme:

1 lb. ground beef (ideally 90% lean)
1 taco seasoning packet
¼ C water

1. Brown the ground beef in a non-stick skillet
2. Once browned, drain fat
3. Add in taco seasoning packet and water, and cook till water is evaporated and meat is well coated in seasoning.

Nut Butter and Banana Open Sandwich



1 large banana
2 TB of almond butter or peanut butter
1 TB honey or maple syrup
1 TB tahini
Toppings of your choice: walnuts, raisins, almond flakes, sesame seeds, chia seeds

1. Slice the banana lengthwise.
2. Mix nut butter with tahini and sweetener of choice.
3. Layer it up and enjoy! This is an easy lunch, great afternoon snack or pre/post workout snack.
Optional: Tahini can be expensive so if you don't have it or don't want to buy it, just don't use it in this recipe. Spreading the peanut butter on the banana without the tahini will still result in a delicious lunch or snack.

Recipe adapted from and picture courtesy of talesofakitchen.com

Basic Egg Salad Sandwich

3 boiled eggs
1-3 TB mayonnaise (to your liking)
1 tsp. mustard
Optional: celery (diced into small pieces), salt, pepper, lettuce
Whole wheat bread

1. How to boil eggs: Place eggs in a pot. Cover them with cool water by 1 inch. Slowly bring water to a boil over medium heat. When the water has reached a boil, cover and remove from heat. Let sit for 12 minutes. Transfer eggs to a colander; place under cool running water to stop the cooking. The eggs can be peeled and served immediately!
2. Once cooled, mush boiled eggs in a bowl with a fork.
3. Add mayo 1 tablespoon at time, depending on how moist you like your salad.
4. Mix in mustard, celery, salt, and pepper.
5. Spread mixture on bread (toasted bread is good as well). Top sandwich with lettuce.

Recipe courtesy of Shayna Bedingfield and marthastewart.com

Basic Tuna Sandwich

1 (7 oz.) can of white tuna packed in water, drained
¼ C mayo or Miracle Whip
5 sweet or dill pickles (cucumber chips), 2 leaves iceberg lettuce, or baby spinach
Whole wheat bread

1. Drain and rinse tuna. In a small bowl, mix tuna with sauce.
2. Spread over whole wheat bread. Add pickles, lettuce, or spinach if desired.

Recipe courtesy of Shayna Bedingfield

Basic Spicy Tuna Melt



1 (7 oz.) can of white tuna packed in water, drained
2 TB mayo or Miracle Whip
1/3 tsp. dill
Pinch of cayenne pepper (or red pepper flakes)
Salt and pepper, to taste
Whole wheat bread
Cheese

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees.
2. Mix tuna, sauce, dill, cayenne, and salt/pepper in a small bowl.
3. Spread mixture over bread. Top with a slice of cheese.
4. Place on a cookie sheet in the oven at 350 degrees for 5-10 minutes.

Recipe courtesy of Shayna Bedingfield

Ramen

What is more college-friendly than ramen? Ramen is cheap and easy to make, but it's not the most nutrient rich food out there. Here are some recipes that use ramen but have some added healthy ingredients.

Start with your basic ramen noodle package and add your favorite protein and vegetables.

Protein Ideas:

Egg, boiled egg
Beef, sautéed in strips
Chicken, sautéed in strips
Pork, sautéed in strips
Tofu

Vegetable Ideas:

Package of frozen Asian vegetables
Carrots
Zucchini
Broccoli
Corn
Peas, Snap Peas
Onions (any variety)

1. Cut up your protein and any fresh vegetables.
2. Heat 2 C of water to boiling. Add Ramen noodles and boil for 5 minutes. Add half of the flavoring packet to reduce sodium content.
3. While you're waiting for the Ramen…
   Fresh vegetables: Stir-fry fresh veggies in pan (coated with cooking spray) over medium heat for 5 minutes. Add meat. Stir-fry until meat is well-cooked.
   Frozen vegetables: Stir-fry meat in pan (coated with cooking spray) over medium-high heat for 5 minutes. Add frozen vegetables and 1-2 TB of water, and stir-fry until veggies are softened.
4. Add veggies and meat to the Ramen, and enjoy!

Recipe courtesy of Shayna Bedingfield

Quick Ramen Bowl



1 package Ramen noodles
1 C fresh spinach
3 medium button mushrooms
2 whole green onions
1 large egg (optional)

1. In a small pot, bring 2 cups of water to a boil. While you are waiting for the water to boil, wash and slice the veggies (spinach, mushrooms, green onions). Add the dry noodles to the boiling water and cook for about 5 minutes. Add the seasoning packet (or half a packet if you prefer less sodium) and stir until dissolved.
2. Turn the heat down to medium and stir in all of the fresh veggies. Allow them to sit in the hot (not boiling) broth for 1-2 minutes or until slightly softened. Voila! You can go ahead and enjoy your Ramen, or follow the next step if you'd like some protein.
3. Make a well in the center of the pot and crack the egg into it. Allow the egg to poach in the broth until the whites are solid but the yolk is still runny. Alternatively, you can break the yolk and stir the pot just slightly to yield egg ribbons like in egg drop soup. The water should not be boiling at this point or else your egg will dissolve into such small pieces that it will give you a cloudy broth.

Recipe and picture courtesy of budgetbytes.com

Cabbage Chicken Ramen Salad

Dressing Ingredients:
½ C white vinegar
½ tsp. sesame oil
¼ C olive oil
2 tbsp. sugar
½ tsp. salt
½ tsp. pepper
1 Ramen noodle chicken seasoning packet

Salad Ingredients:
1 head cabbage, sliced thin
1 can drained chicken or 2 C cooked chicken chunks
1 package dry, crumbled Ramen noodles
Optional: mandarin oranges, sliced almonds, sliced green onions

1. Whisk together ingredients for sauce.
2. Chop cabbage into thin slices. Crumble noodles. In a large bowl, mix together cabbage, chicken, and noodles. Pour sauce over mixture and stir. If desired, add mandarin oranges, sliced almonds, and sliced green onions.
3. Refrigerate for 30 minutes. Serve cold.

Recipe courtesy of Shayna Bedingfield

Sandwich Ideas

Sandwiches are a great lunch staple and are very simple and easy to make. Getting bored of plain old peanut butter and jelly? Here are some ideas from USU dietetic students to try to spice up your everyday sandwiches.

Breads:
Bread
Tortilla
Pita bread
Naan bread (or other flat bread)
Roll
Bun
French bread or other artisan breads
English muffins
Ciabatta



Spread:
Fancy mustard
Hummus
Pesto
Cream cheese (plain or herbed)
Mayonnaise (plain or flavored)
Ranch or other salad dressings
Salsa
Guacamole
Mashed beans



Protein:
Deli meat
Grilled chicken
Cooked egg
Sausage
Roasted turkey or other meat
Tuna
Cheese
Beans
Tofu
Veggie Burgers
Egg salad (or chicken salad)
Lentils



Vegetables:
Lettuce
Spinach

Tomatoes
Chopped carrots
Pickles
Coleslaw
Peppers (green, red, yellow, orange, or hot)
Onions
Avocado
Cucumber
Mushroom
Sprouts

Cucumber Sandwiches (makes 4)

8 thick slices whole-wheat bread
½ cup (4 oz.) cream cheese, softened (can be plain or flavored as desired)
1 to 2 English cucumbers sliced into about 24 pieces
½ cup alfalfa sprouts
4 tsp. olive oil
4 tsp. red wine vinegar
2 tomatoes, sliced
4 lettuce leaves
1 cup sliced pepperoncini or banana peppers
2 avocados, peeled, seeded, and mashed

1. Spread about 1 tablespoon of cream cheese on each bread slice. Arrange the cucumbers in a single layer over 4 bread slices, cover with sprouts, and sprinkle with oil and vinegar.
2. Layer on the tomatoes, lettuce, and pepperoncini.
3. Spread avocados over the cream cheese on the remaining 4 slices of bread, Place spread-side down on pepperoncini and serve right away.

Recipe adapted from allrecipes.com

Caprese Wraps with Chicken

2 tbsp. olive oil
2 tbsp. white wine vinegar
¼ tsp salt
¼ tsp black pepper
4 cups hearts of romaine lettuce, chopped
1 ½ cups shredded boneless, skinless chicken breast (can use rotisserie chicken if desired)
¾ cup (3 oz.) fresh mozzarella cheese, cut into small pieces
½ cup fresh basil leaves, torn
1 pint cherry tomatoes, quartered
Cooking spray or additional olive oil
4 multigrain flatbreads or pita breads
1 large garlic clove, halved

1. Combine first 4 ingredients in a large bowl and whisk together. Add lettuce, chicken, mozzarella, basil, and tomatoes and toss to combine.
2. Heat a large nonstick skillet over medium-high heat. Spray with cooking spray or drizzle lightly with olive oil. Cook each flatbread or pita bread individually about 1 minute per side. Rube each side of the bread with the cut sides of the garlic. Arrange about 1 ½ cups of the caprese mixture in the center of the flat bread and roll up. If using pita bread, cut in half and stuff the inside of the pita with desired amount of caprese mixture.

Recipe from myrecipes.com

